

It's all too simple for fake news to propagate thanks to artificially intelligent bots, "trolls" who are purposely rude and spiteful, as well as micro-targeting and targeted marketing. People with cognitive biases are more receptive to disinformation. We tend to post tales on social media that make us feel something, and we're more inclined to engage with information that gets a lot of "likes," comments, or retweets — regardless of whether the content is real or fake.

Investigators discovered that a corporation called Cambridge Analytica acquired psychological profile data from unwitting users in the Cambridge Analytica affair. Bad actors exploited this information to try to sway the 2016 election by microtargeting individuals with false information and exploiting emotional biases to spread fake news stories that swayed political attitudes.

The Importance of Credible Sources

The greatest strategy to combat the spread of disinformation is to fact-check claims with trustworthy information from credible sources. You can verify whether or not a claim you read on social media or in an internet article is true by double-checking it. When fact-checking material, it's critical to use reliable, trustworthy sources; otherwise, you risk continuing the cycle.

What Makes a Source Credible?

For a casual internet user, it might be unclear when it comes to the authenticity of information sources. It's not always evident which websites and articles are trustworthy. To one person, a website may appear trustworthy, but not to another.

There are some criteria you can use to evaluate an article on a website:

- **Authority:** Contact information, developer/owner information, and author credentials/qualifications should all be included on the website.
- **Purpose:** The website's purpose should be obvious, with articles that support it; you may identify purpose by looking at the domain's URL — .gov sites are government sites, .edu sites are college and univer-

